Unlock benefits worth ₹36,000 and more. Explore now

This article applies to selling in: **India**

Upcoming changes to the buyer-initiated order cancellation process

On this page

Seller Central - Manage orders page changes
Unofficial buyer-initiated cancellation process that will impact your cancellation rate metrics
Order report changes
API Changes (Selling Partner (SP) - API)
Frequently Asked Questions
Resources

Effective from May 23, 2022, we are changing the way sellers manage buyer-initiated order cancellations for seller-fulfilled orders.

Seller Central - Manage orders page changes

Cancellation process:

To request an official order cancellation, a buyer must go to **Your Account**, click **Your Orders** and select **Request cancellation**.

- If the buyer requests a cancellation after 30 minutes of placing their order, you receive an e-mail notification and will also be able to view the cancellation request on the **Manage Orders** page, right above the order information, with a banner stating **The buyer has requested that this order be cancelled. Cancelling this order will not affect your cancellation rate metric.**
- When cancelling the order, select the cancellation reason as **Buyer Cancelled** which will exclude this order from your cancellation rate metric.
- After you cancel the order, you and the buyer will receive separate e-mails confirming that the order has been cancelled.

> **Note:** Selecting the reason for cancellation as **Buyer Cancelled** for an order cancellation that was not initiated by a buyer will impact your cancellation rate metrics.

To cancel an order requested by a buyer, follow the steps mentioned below:

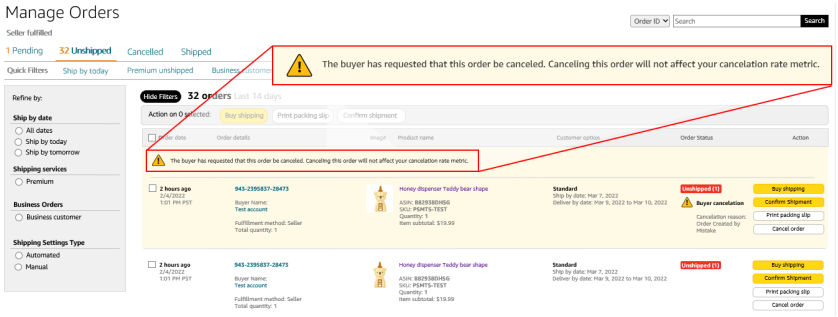
1. Sign in to your Seller Central account. Go to **Orders**, click Manage Orders.
2. View orders with buyer-initiated cancellation by looking for the banner stating **The buyer has requested that this order be cancelled. Cancelling this order will not affect your cancellation rate metric**.
3. Click **Cancel order** under the **Action** column.

   > **Note:** The **Cancel order** option is available for **Unshipped** orders only.

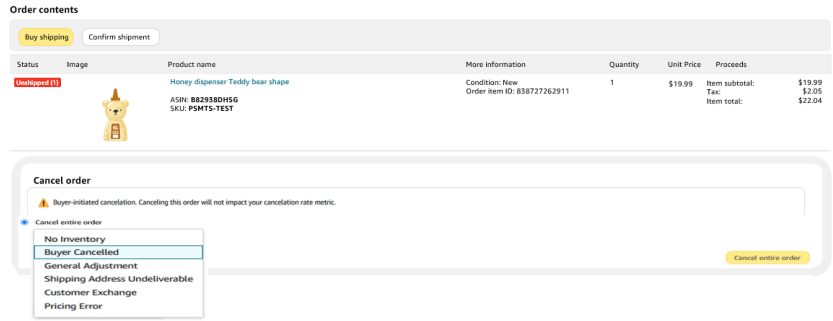
4. On the **Order details** page, select the reason for cancellation as **Buyer Cancelled**.
5. Click **Submit**.

> **Note:** After you cancel the order, you and the buyer will receive separate e-mails confirming that the order has been cancelled.

The images below show example of Step 2 and 3. On your **Manage orders** page, select the order that you want to cancel and click **Cancel order**.



Example of Step 4. From the drop-down menu, select the reason for cancellation as **Buyer cancelled**.



> **Note:** If you cannot fulfil the order due to lack of inventory and need to cancel the order, select the reason as **No Inventory**. Do not contact the buyer and request that they submit a cancellation request.

Unofficial buyer-initiated cancellation process that will impact your cancellation rate metrics

A buyer requesting a cancellation solely via the Buyer-Seller messaging service without following the official cancellation process is considered an unofficial channel for buyers to cancel orders. Accordingly, if you cancel an order in response to a request from a buyer via the Buyer-Seller messaging service, this unofficial cancellation will impact your cancellation rate metric.

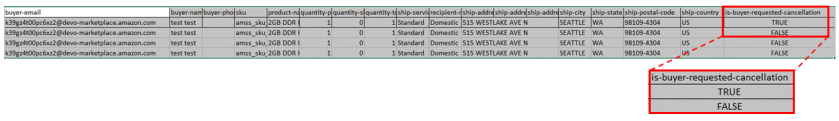
To avoid cancelling an order in a manner that impacts your metrics, you can respond to the buyer's message and request the buyer to submit a cancellation using the official process above.

Use the following instructions in your response: “You can find the order in your Amazon account. Go to **Your Account**, then click **Your Orders** and select **Request cancellation**."

Order report changes

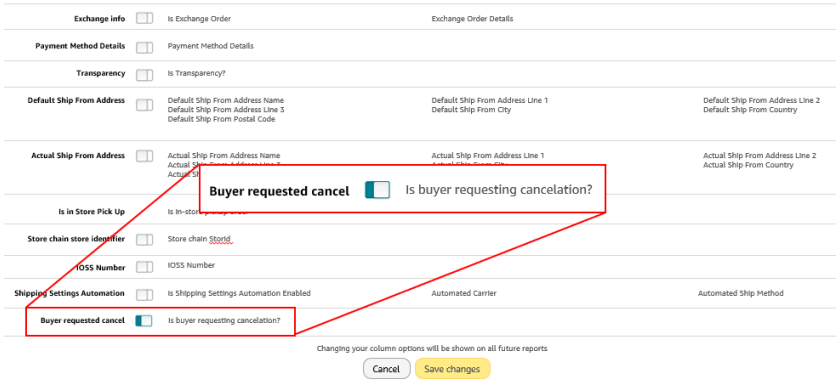
For sellers who use order reports to process orders, an optional additional field called **is-buyer-requested-cancelation** is available on your order reports. The **is-buyer-requested-cancelation** column will have a **TRUE** value if there is a buyer cancellation request for the order, and **FALSE** otherwise.

You can view the image below.



You can view all orders which have buyer-initiated cancellation requests in your order reports by switching on the toggle option for the field called **Buyer Requested Cancel** available by accessing Add or remove order report columns.

You can view the image below.



API Changes (Selling Partner (SP) - API)

Orders API

To highlight buyer-requested cancellations to sellers, Amazon will be updating the **Orders API** section.

Selling partner (SP) - API

Similar to the orders API, for SP-API, when a buyer initiates an order cancellation request:

1. The **ordersV0GettOrderItemsList** operation will include an **isBuyerRequestedCancel** flag and **buyerCancelReason** string for each **OrderItem** in the response when the order has a buyer-initiated cancellation.

2. The **isBuyerRequestedCancel** flag will be set to **True** if the order has a buyer-initiated cancellation request.

3. The **buyerCancelReason** will display the reason for cancellation specified by the buyer.

Frequently Asked Questions

1. Why did you make these changes?

We received feedback from sellers saying that they would like to be notified of buyer-initiated order cancellations in a way that they would not miss these requests, thereby reducing returns and refunds.

2. How is the cancellation rate metric calculated? Has anything changed?

There are no changes to the cancellation rate policy or how the cancellation rate metric is calculated. For more information, go to Cancellation rate.

3. Is there a change in the way I get notified if a buyer requests a cancellation via the official cancellation process?

Yes. You will be notified about the official buyer-initiated cancellation request via:

1. E-mail
2. **Manage orders** page on Seller Central
3. Order reports
4. Orders API response (SP-API)

4. Do I have to download order reports to be able to see buyer-initiated cancellations?

No. If you do not use order reports, you will be notified of buyer-initiated cancellations through e-mail, the **Manage orders** page on Seller Central, and via APIs. The advantage of downloading order reports is that you are able to see all buyer-initiated cancellations in a single report. You will need to switch the toggle option to enable the field called **Buyer Requested Cancel**.

5. Will I continue to receive order cancellation requests from buyers via the Buyer-Seller messaging service?

If a buyer requests an order cancellation via the Buyer-Seller messaging service only, it is considered an unofficial request. If you cancel the order, your cancellation rate metric will be impacted.

6. What should I do if I receive a cancellation request on Buyer-Seller messaging service?

Buyer-Seller messaging is considered an unofficial channel for buyers to request an order cancellation. To avoid cancelling an order in a way that affects your metrics, respond to the buyer's message and request them to submit a cancellation request using the official process.

Use the following instructions in your response: “You can find the order in your Amazon account. Go to **Your Account**, click **Your Orders** and select **Request Cancellation**.

7. Will I be able to use the Buyer-Seller messaging service to send messages to buyers after this change?

Yes, you can continue to communicate with the buyers using Buyer-Seller messages in the same way you currently do today.

Messages about cancellation are considered a critical message, and will be delivered to a buyer even if they have opted out of non-critical messages.

8. What happens if I choose not to accept the buyer’s order cancellation request?

At this time, if the buyer initiates the order cancellation and you choose to go ahead and ship the order, it will not negatively impact your cancellation rate metric.

9. Will this update change the kind of cancellations that will negatively affect my cancellation rate metric?

No, this update will not change the kind of cancellations that can negatively affect your cancellation rate metric.

Cancellation initiated by	Cancellation scenario	Negatively affect cancellation rate?
Buyer	1. I am cancelling as the buyer submitted an official cancellation request	No
	2. I am cancelling as the buyer asked me to cancel solely through Buyer-Seller messaging service (unofficial cancellation processes)	Yes
Seller	1. I am cancelling as my item went out of stock	Yes
	2. I am cancelling as the address was undeliverable	Yes
	3. I am cancelling as the buyer was unresponsive	Yes
Amazon	1. The order was auto-cancelled by Amazon as the seller did not confirm shipment within 1 day of ship-by-date	Yes
	2. The order was auto-cancelled by Amazon as we detected the buyer to be fraudulent	No
	3. Payment verification failed so the order was cancelled by Amazon	No

Resources

Order cancellations

Cancellations FAQ

Need more help?

Visit Seller Forums

See more on Seller Central

© 2025 Amazon.com Services LLC.